CSE 114A

Foundations of Programming Languages

Monads

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Based on course materials developed by Nadia Polikarpova and Ranjit Jhala

Abstracting Code Patterns

```
data List a
  = []
  | (:) a (List a)
```


Abstracting Code Patterns

Rendering the Values of a List

```
-- >>> showList [1, 2, 3]
-- ["1", "2", "3"]
showList        :: [Int] -> [String]
showList []     =  []
showList (n:ns) =  show n : showList ns
```

Squaring the values of a list

```
-- >>> sqrList [1, 2, 3]
-- 1, 4, 9
sqrList        :: [Int] -> [Int]
sqrList []     =  []
sqrList (n:ns) =  n^2 : sqrList ns
```

Common Pattern: map over a list

Refactor iteration into mapList

```
mapList :: (a -> b) -> [a] -> [b]
mapList f []     = []
mapList f (x:xs) = f x : mapList f xs
```

Reuse map to implement inc and sqr

```
showList xs = map (\n -> show n) xs

sqrList  xs = map (\n -> n ^ 2)  xs
```


What about trees?

```
data Tree a
  = Leaf
  | Node a (Tree a) (Tree a)
```


What about trees?

```
-- >>> showTree (Node 2 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 3 Leaf Leaf))
-- (Node "2" (Node "1" Leaf Leaf) (Node "3" Leaf Leaf))
showTree :: Tree Int -> Tree String
showTree Leaf         = ???
showTree (Node v l r) = ???

-- >>> sqrTree (Node 2 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 3 Leaf Leaf))
-- (Node 4 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 9 Leaf Leaf))
sqrTree :: Tree Int -> Tree Int
sqrTree Leaf         = ???
sqrTree (Node v l r) = ???
```

QUIZ

Refactor iteration into mapTree! What should the type of mapTree be?

```
mapTree :: ???
showTree t = mapTree (\n -> show n) t
sqrTree  t = mapTree (\n -> n ^ 2)  t
```

(A) (Int -> Int) -> Tree Int -> Tree Int
(B) (Int -> String) -> Tree Int -> Tree String
(C) (Int -> a) -> Tree Int -> Tree a
(D) (a -> a) -> Tree a -> Tree a
(E) (a -> b) -> Tree a -> Tree b

http://tiny.cc/cse116-maptree-ind

QUIZ

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mapTree :: ???
showTree t = mapTree (\n -> show n) t
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```

(A) (Int -> Int) -> Tree Int -> Tree Int
(B) (Int -> String) -> Tree Int -> Tree String
(C) (Int -> a) -> Tree Int -> Tree a
(D) (a -> a) -> Tree a -> Tree a
(E) (a -> b) -> Tree a -> Tree b

http://tiny.cc/cse116-maptree-grp

Lets write mapTree

```
mapTree :: (a -> b) -> Tree a -> Tree b
mapTree f Leaf         = ???
mapTree f (Node v l r) = ???
```

Wait … there is a common pattern across two *datatypes*

```
mapList :: (a -> b) -> List a -> List b     -- List
mapTree :: (a -> b) -> Tree a -> Tree b     -- Tree
gmap    :: (Mappable t) => (a -> b) -> t a  -> t b
```

Lets make a **class** for it!

```
class Functor t where
  fmap :: ???
```

QUIZ

```
class Functor t where
  fmap :: ???
```

What type should we give to fmap?

(A) (b -> a) -> t b -> t a
(B) (a -> a) -> t a -> t a
(C) (a -> b) -> [a] -> [b]
(D) (a -> b) -> t a -> t b
(E) (a -> b) -> Tree a -> Tree b

http://tiny.cc/cse116-fmap-ind

QUIZ

```
class Functor t where
  fmap :: ???
```

What type should we give to fmap?

(A) (b -> a) -> t b -> t a
(B) (a -> a) -> t a -> t a
(C) (a -> b) -> [a] -> [b]
(D) (a -> b) -> t a -> t b
(E) (a -> b) -> Tree a -> Tree b

http://tiny.cc/cse116-fmap-grp

Reuse Iteration Across Types

```
instance Functor [] where
  fmap = mapList

instance Functor Tree where
  fmap = mapTree
```

And now we can do

```
-- >>> fmap (\n -> n^2) (Node 2 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 3 Leaf Leaf))
-- (Node 4 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 9 Leaf Leaf))

-- >>> fmap show [1,2,3]
-- ["1", "2", "3"]
```

Exercise: Write a Functor instance

```
data Result  a
  = Error String
  | Ok    a
instance Functor Result where
  fmap f (Error msg) = ???
  fmap f (Ok val)    = ???
```

When you're done you should see

```
>>> fmap (\n -> n ^ 2) (Error "oh no")
(Error "oh no")
>>> fmap (\n -> n ^ 2) (Ok (Node 2 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 3 Leaf Leaf)))
(Ok (Node 4 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 9 Leaf Leaf)))
```


Exercise: Write a Functor instance

```
data Result  a
  = Error String
  | Ok    a

instance Functor Result where
  fmap f (Error msg) = ???
  fmap f (Ok val)    = ???
```

When you're done you should see

```
-- >>> fmap (\n -> n ^ 2) (Error "oh no")
          (Node 2 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 3 Leaf Leaf))
-- (Node 4 (Node 1 Leaf Leaf) (Node 9 Leaf Leaf))
```


Next: A Class for Sequencing

Recall our old Expr datatype

```
data Expr
  = Number Int
  | Plus   Expr Expr
  | Div    Expr Expr
  deriving (Show)

eval :: Expr -> Int
eval (Number n)   = n
eval (Plus e1 e2) = eval e1   +   eval e2
eval (Div  e1 e2) = eval e1 `div` eval e2

-- >>> eval (Div (Number 6) (Number 2))
-- 3
```

But, what is the result

```
-- >>> eval (Div (Number 6) (Number 0))
-- *** Exception: divide by zero
```

A crash! Lets look at an alternative approach to avoid dividing by zero.

The idea is to return a Result Int (instead of a plain Int)

- If a *sub-expression* had a divide by zero, return Error "..."
- If all sub-expressions were safe, then return the actual Result v

But, what is the result

```
eval :: Expr -> Result Int
eval (Number n)   = OK n
eval (Plus e1 e2) = case eval e1 of
                    Error err1 -> Error err1
                    OK v1   -> case eval e2 of
                               Error err2 -> Error err2
                               OK v2   -> OK (v1 + v2)
eval (Div e1 e2)  = case eval e1 of
                    Error err1 -> Error err1
                    OK v1   -> case eval e2 of
                               Error err2 -> Error err2
                               OK v2   ->
                                 if v2 == 0
                                   then Error ("yikes dbz:" ++ show e2)
                                   else OK (v1 `div` v2)
```


But, what is the result

The **good news**, no nasty exceptions, just a plain Error result

```
λ> eval (Div (Number 6) (Number 2))
Value 3
λ> eval (Div (Number 6) (Number 0))
Error "yikes dbz:Number 0"
λ> eval (Div (Number 6) (Plus (Number 2) (Number (-2))))
Error "yikes dbz:Plus (Number 2) (Number (-2))"
```

The **bad news**: the code is super duper **gross**

Let's spot a Pattern

The code is gross because we have these cascading blocks

```
case e1 of
  Error err1 -> Error err1
  Value v1   -> case e2 of
                Error err2 -> Error err2
                Value v1   -> Result (v1 + v2)
```

but really both blocks have something **common pattern**

```
case e of
  Error err -> Error err
  Value v   -> {- do stuff with v -}
```

1. Evaluate e
2. If the result is an Error then *return* that error.
3. If the result is a Value v then *do some further processing* on v.

Let's spot a Pattern

Lets **bottle** that common structure in two functions:

- >>= (pronounced *bind*)
- return (pronounced *return*)

```
(>>=) :: Result a -> (a -> Result b) -> Result b
(Error err) >>= _       = Error err
(Ok v)   >>= process = process v

return :: a -> Result a
return v = Ok v
```

NOTE: return is *not* a keyword; it is just the name of a function!

A Cleaned up Evaluator

The magic bottle lets us clean up our eval

```
eval :: Expr -> Result Int
eval (Number n)   = return n
eval (Plus e1 e2) = eval e1 >>= \v1 ->
                    eval e2 >>= \v2 ->
                    return (v1 + v2)
eval (Div e1 e2)  = eval e1 >>= \v1 ->
                    eval e2 >>= \v2 ->
                    if v2 == 0
                      then Error ("yikes dbz:" ++ show e2)
                      else return (v1 `div` v2)
```

The gross *pattern matching* is all hidden inside >>=

A Cleaned up Evaluator

Notice the >>= takes *two* inputs of type:

- Result Int (e.g. eval e1 or eval e2)
- Int -> Result Int (e.g. The *processing* function that takes the v and does stuff with it)

In the above, the processing functions are written using

\v1 -> ... and \v2 -> ...

NOTE: It is *crucial* that you understand what the code above is doing, and why it is actually just a "shorter" version of the (gross) nested-case-of eval.

A Class for >>=

Like fmap or show or jval or ==, the >>= operator is useful across many types, so we capture it in an interface/typeclass:

```
class Monad m where
  (>>=)  :: m a -> (a -> m b) -> m b
  return :: a -> m a
```

Notice how the definitions for Result fit the above, with m = Result

```
instance Monad Result where
  (>>=) :: Result a -> (a -> Result b) -> Result b
  (Error err) >>= _       = Error err
  (Ok v)   >>= process = process v

  return :: a -> Result a
  return v = Ok v
```


Syntax for >>=

In fact >>= is *so* useful there is special syntax for it.

Instead of writing

```
e1 >>= \v1 ->
e2 >>= \v2 ->
e3 >>= \v3 ->
e
```

you can write

```
do v1 <- e1
   v2 <- e2
   v3 <- e3
   e
```

...

Syntax for >>=

Thus, we can further simplify our eval to:

```
eval :: Expr -> Result Int
eval (Number n)   = return n
eval (Plus e1 e2) = do v1 <- eval e1
                       v2 <- eval e2
                       return (v1 + v2)
eval (Div e1 e2)  = do v1 <- eval e1
                       v2 <- eval e2
                       if v2 == 0
                         then Error ("yikes dbz:" ++ show e2)
                         else return (v1 `div` v2)
```


Purity and the Immutability Principle

Haskell is a **pure** language. Not a *value* judgment, but a precise *technical* statement:

The "Immutability Principle":

- A function must *always* return the same output for a given input
- A function's behavior should *never change*

No Side Effects

Haskell's most radical idea: expression ==> value

- When you evaluate an expression you get a value and **nothing else happens**

Specifically, evaluation must not have any **side effects**

- *change* a global variable or
- *print* to screen or
- *read* a file or
- *send* an email or
- *launch* a missile.

Purity means functions may depend only on their inputs

functions should give the same output for the same input every time

But… how to write “Hello, world!”

But, we *want* to …

- print to screen
- read a file
- send an email

A language that only lets you write factorial and fibonacci is … *not very useful*!

Thankfully, you *can* do all the above via a very clever idea: Recipe

Recipes

Haskell has a special type called IO - which you can think of as Recipe

```
type Recipe a = IO a
```

A *value* of type Recipe a is

- a **description** of an effectful computations
- **when executed** (possibly) perform some effectful I/O operations to
- **produce** a value of type a.

This analogy is due to Joachim Brietner

Recipes have No Effects

A value of type Recipe a is

- Just a **description** of an effectful computation
- An inert, perfectly safe thing with **no effects**.

Merely having a Recipe Cake has no effects: holding the recipe

- Does not make your oven *hot*
- Does not make your your floor *dirty*

Executing Recipes

There is **only one way** to execute a Recipe a

Haskell looks for a special value

```
main :: Recipe ()
```

The value associated with main is handed to the **runtime system and executed**

The Haskell runtime is the only one allowed to cook!

How to write an App in Haskell

Make a Recipe () that is handed off to the master chef main.

- main can be arbitrarily complicated
- will be composed of *many smaller* recipes

Hello World

```
putStrLn :: String -> Recipe ()
```

The function putStrLn

- takes as input a String
- returns as output a Recipe ()

putStrLn msg is a Recipe () *when executed* prints out msg on the screen.

```
main :: Recipe ()
main = putStrLn "Hello, world!"
```

... and we can compile and run it

```
$ ghc --make hello.hs
$ ./hello
Hello, world!
```

QUIZ: Combining Recipes

Next, lets write a program that prints multiple things:

```
main :: IO ()
main = combine (putStrLn "Hello,") (putStrLn "World!")

-- putStrLn :: String -> Recipe ()
-- combine  :: ???
```

What must the *type* of combine be?

(A) combine :: () -> () -> ()
(B) combine :: Recipe () -> Recipe () -> Recipe ()
(C) combine :: Recipe a -> Recipe a -> Recipe a
(D) combine :: Recipe a -> Recipe b -> Recipe b
(E) combine :: Recipe a -> Recipe b -> Recipe a

Using Intermediate Results

Next, lets write a program that

1. **Asks** for the user's name using
   getLine :: Recipe String
2. **Prints** out a greeting with that name using
   putStrLn :: String -> Recipe ()

Problem: How to pass the **output** of *first* recipe into the *second* recipe?

QUIZ: Using Yolks to Make Batter

Suppose you have two recipes

```
crack     :: Recipe Yolk
eggBatter :: Yolk -> Recipe Batter
```

and we want to get

```
mkBatter :: Recipe Batter
mkBatter = crack `combineWithResult` eggBatter
```

What must the type of combineWithResult be?

(A) Yolk -> Batter -> Batter
(B) Recipe Yolk -> (Yolk -> Recipe Batter) -> Recipe Batter
(C) Recipe a -> (a -> Recipe a) -> Recipe a
(D) Recipe a -> (a -> Recipe b) -> Recipe b
(E) Recipe Yolk -> (Yolk -> Recipe Batter) -> Recipe ()

Look Familiar?

Wait a bit, the signature looks familiar!

```
combineWithResult :: Recipe a -> (a -> Recipe b) -> Recipe b
```

Remember this?

```
(>>=)          :: Result a -> (a -> Result b) -> Result b
```


Recipe is an instance of Monad

```
instance Monad Recipe where
  (>>=) = {-... combineWithResult... -}
```

So we can put this together with putStrLn to get:

```
main :: Recipe ()
main = getLine >>= \name -> putStrLn ("Hello, " ++ name ++ "!")
```

or, using **do** notation the above becomes

```
main :: Recipe ()
main = do name <- getLine
          putStrLn ("Hello, " ++ name ++ "!")
```


Recipe is an instance of Monad

Exercise

1. *Compile* and run to make sure its ok!
2. *Modify* the above to repeatedly ask for names.
3. *Extend* the above to print a “prompt” that tells you how many iterations have occurred.

Monads are Amazing

Monads have had a *revolutionary* influence in PL, well beyond Haskell, some recent examples

- **Error handling** in go e.g. 1 and 2
- **Asynchrony** in JavaScript e.g. 1 and 2
- **Big data** pipelines e.g. LinQ and TensorFlow
- and **Language-based security**!